Guzo Charge

EV CHARGING · ADDIS ABABA, ETHIOPIA

Made-in-Ethiopia EV charging, built on the open-source OpenEVSE platform — charge-point operation, install/EPC and an OCPP + Telebirr software layer, with a differentiated, locally-assembled hardware line.

VERDICT **CONDITIONAL GO** · SERVICE-FIRST HYBRID

$250K
SEED ROUND
June 2026

~115,000 EVs on the road, almost all in Addis	**~200** charging stations completed nationwide	**2,230** stations needed by 2030–2035	**57%** base-case hardware gross margin

The opportunity

Ethiopia banned petrol/diesel car imports and is running Africa's fastest EV transition. **~115,000 EVs nationally (concentrated in Addis Ababa)** already operate against only **~200 stations**. The state can't close the gap alone, so **EVCS Directive No. 1034/2024** requires EV importers, fuel stations, hotels and developers to install charging. No domestic charger manufacturer exists in Ethiopia or East Africa.

What we build

Charge-point operation — own/host AC chargers; energy by session or subscription.

Install / EPC — turnkey charging for mandated buyers (importers, hotels, developers).

Hardware — OpenEVSE-based AC units (CC BY-SA 3.0/GPL-3.0), assembled and serviced locally.

Software / SaaS — OCPP smart-charging + Telebirr billing; recurring, sticky revenue.

Why we win — on value, not price

- On-the-ground **service & warranty** an imported box can't match.
- **Localization**: Telebirr/CBE Birr, Amharic UI, load-shedding auto-restart, Type 2 + GB/T for the Chinese fleet.
- **OCPP software moat** turning hardware into recurring revenue.
- **Open-source credibility** for NGO/donor/diplomatic tenders.
- **"Made in Ethiopia"** aligned to the National E-Mobility Strategy 2025–2030.

Unit economics · 32A / 7.4 kW

Per unit (USD)	Low	Mid	High
Total COGS	$109	$174	$261
Retail (smart AC)	$320	$400	$480
Gross margin	**66%**	**57%**	**46%**

vs imported Chinese 7 kW OEM ~$158–250 FOB — we compete on value, not price.

3-year scenarios

Scenario	Units/mo	ASP	GM
Conservative	20	$350	45%
Base	60	$400	52%
Optimistic	150	$430	57%

Breakeven ~35–45 units/mo hardware-only (sooner with CPO/service revenue). Payback ~24–36 months (base case).

The ask · use of funds

$250K seed

Covers Phase 1–2 (validation → small-scale assembly) + working-capital buffer. Deployed across: first inventory & imports, assembly/test setup, core team, certification & licensing, OCPP+Telebirr software, and runway.

Structure

Fully local Ethiopian PLC. Founder's diaspora "Yellow Card" gives **domestic-investor** treatment — sidestepping the USD 200,000 foreign minimum while keeping diaspora FX-account & finance access.

BEFORE CAPITAL IS DEPLOYED — KEY ITEMS TO VALIDATE

Confirm the EVSE customs/VAT exemption on HS 8504.40/8543.70 (mixed components may face 5–35%+cascade); re-verify the PEA charging tariff (14–18 ETB/kWh (~$0.09–0.12) sits above EEU's general ~3–5 ETB/kWh); confirm ESI certification timeline, EVCS licence fees, and EIC incentive scope. FX risk: USD/ETB ≈ 158–161; price USD-indexed.